ACADEMIC PROGRAMS AND DEGREES

RHU offers 17 accredited programs in three Colleges: Business Administration, Engineering, and Arts and Sciences. The language of instruction is English. Below is a summary of the programs offered, degrees awarded, and the number of credits required to complete a degree. All programs include 30 credits for general education courses.

College/ Program	Degree	Credits
College of Arts and Sciences		
English Language (currently frozen)	BA	93
Computer Science	BS	93
Healthcare Information Systems (Currently Frozen)	BS	100
Graphic Design	BS	111
Freshman Arts/Science		30
College of Business Administration		
Accounting	BBA	99
Business IT Management	BBA	99
Management	BBA	99
Human Resources Management	BBA	99
Marketing and Advertising	BBA	99
Finance and Banking	BBA	99
College of Engineering		
Civil Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152
Biomedical Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152
Computer and Communications Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152
Electrical Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152
Mechanical Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152
Mechatronics Engineering	BS, BE, MS	118, 152

ADMISSION

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The RHU Admissions Office manages all admission-related functions. The spectrum of responsibilities includes managing admission applications; developing, maintaining, and implementing admissions policies and procedures; working closely with the academic units and University committees on admission issues; continuously engaging with prospective students by helping them complete their application dossier, responding to their inquiries and supporting them in making informative academic choices, and informing them of the admission decision and related stipulations; managing enrollment campaigns and meetings with school principals, parents and community leaders; preparing and updating admission materials; participating in the organization of students' open-day and orientation programs; and generating admission statistics and reports.

Applications for admission may be submitted via mail, email, online, or in person. Admission to RHU is competitive; students with strong high school records may receive early admission. For details on admission requirements, application deadlines, procedures, and fees for various University programs, please refer to the Admission section in this catalog or visit www.rhu.edu.lb/admission

Undergraduate Admission

General Information

Rafik Hariri University admits academically qualified and morally sound students irrespective of origin, color, gender, religion, or disability. RHU notifies students of its decision to accept them within four weeks of receiving their complete application and supporting documents. Outstanding students may receive early admission to RHU based on their academic achievement in high school.

Fulfilling the following admission requirements does not guarantee admission to a program. These requirements constitute a threshold for inclusion in the competition pool. Admission is competitive and subject to the availability of spaces in the desired program. The following stipulations pertain to admission to undergraduate programs. Admission requirements for graduate studies are in the Graduate Catalog.

Admission Requirements

Applicants to RHU must satisfy the following basic requirements: (1) attained the prerequisite education for the program of interest; (2) have not been expelled from another institution for academic or misconduct reasons; (3) completed and submitted the

application form and all application materials to the Admissions Office by the stated deadlines and paid the application fee (4) submitted all required certified documents; and (5) provided photocopies of passport and residence permit (for non-Lebanese applicants).

Students may register for their courses after completing all RHU admission requirements.

Academic Preparation

To be admitted, the student must have completed at least 12 years of schooling before joining the University and provide proof of English-language proficiency as detailed below.

Lebanese Baccalaureate. Students with a Lebanese High School Certificate may be admitted to their desired undergraduate program, subject to the requirements specified in the following table.

College	Baccalaureate Study Track
Arts and Sciences	General and Life Sciences, Sociology & Economics*, Humanities & Literature**
Business Administration	General and Life Sciences, Sociology & Economics, Humanities & Literature***,
Engineering	General and Life Sciences, Sociology & Economics*
* Sociology & Economics track students must take two remedial Math courses as a prerequisite to joining Computer Science offered by the College of Arts and Sciences, or four remedial courses, two Math and two Physics, as a prerequisite to joining any program provided by the College of Engineering, provided that grade 11 is in the scientific track. ** Humanities and Literature track students can enroll in all majors offered by the College of Arts and Sciences except for Computer Science. *** Humanities and Literature track students must take one remedial Math course as a prerequisite for admission to the Business Administration program.	

Lebanese Technical Baccalaureate. Students with a Technical Baccalaureate Certificate may pursue a degree in a major corresponding to the technical degree area of specialization, as stipulated by the Lebanese Ministry of Higher Education Decree #779/M/2013. The student must complete the remedial courses specified in the table below.

College	Majors	Course Category (# credits)
Arts and Sciences	• Computer Science	• Mathematics (6 credits) • Physics (3 credits) • Chemistry (3 credits)
Business Administration	All majors	• Mathematics (3 credits) • Statistics (3 credits) • Economics (3 credits)
Engineering	All majors	• Mathematics (6 credits)

		• Physics (6 credits) • Chemistry (3 credits)

Foreign Secondary Level Certificate. Holders of a foreign certificate equivalent to the Lebanese Official High School diploma, such as the Official Secondary Certificate from Arab Countries, the French Baccalaureate, the International Baccalaureate, or the German Abitur, may enroll in an appropriate program, provided that the Ministry of Education validates the certificate.

High School Diploma. A student who holds a High School Diploma (American system) may be admitted to the freshman program if the following conditions are met: (1) The student has completed 12 years of study; (2) the certificate is recognized by the public authorities in the country of origin; and (3) certified copy of the permission to join the Freshman Program from the Equivalence Committee of the Lebanese Ministry of Higher Education.

General Certificate of Education (GCE). An applicant with a British Certificate may be admitted to the freshman program if s/he has completed 5 Ordinary Level courses, 1 Advanced Level, and 12 years of study. Applicants with A-levels who have completed a minimum of five subjects at the Ordinary Level and three subjects at the Advanced Level, or six Advanced Supplementary (AS) subjects, excluding languages, can be admitted to the sophomore program.

Placement Exams

Students are required to provide evidence of English language proficiency and college-level skills in key areas relevant to the major they wish to pursue. This evidence may be submitted in the form of standardized test scores such as TOEFL or SAT, or by taking the RHU placement exams as indicated in the table below. Depending on their performance, students may be required to take remedial courses to improve their competencies and prepare them for the rigor of related college-level courses.

College	Placement Exam
Arts and Sciences	• English
Business Administration*	• English
Engineering*	• English

English Language Proficiency Requirements

English is the language of instruction in all programs offered at RHU. Applicants must, therefore, demonstrate English language proficiency by passing the RHU English Entrance Exam with a minimum score of 380 or by achieving a minimum score on Standardized English competency exams as follows:

Standardized English Exam	Minimum Scores
Institutional TOEFL (ITP)/ RHU In-House TOEFL	550
Internet-Based TOEFL (IBT)	80
IELTS	6.5
SAT: Reading & Writing Evidence-Based	530+

Students who fail to attain the requisite score must enroll in the Intensive English Program (IELP) to achieve the required level of English proficiency. The IELP consists of three levels, and the student is placed at the appropriate level based on the English proficiency examination score.

RHU recognizes an Institutional TOEFL score as valid for one year from the test date. However, the IBT, SAT, and IELTS scores are valid for two years.

Application Procedure

Prospective students may submit applications via one of the following methods.

Apply in person by visiting the Admissions Office:

Rafik Hariri University
Block E
Mechref Village
Damour- Lebanon

Apply online: https://www.rhu.edu.lb/apply

Required Documents

Applications for undergraduate admission must include the following officially certified documents:

1. Original grades of the last three high school years.
2. Certified copy of high school certificate or diploma: Lebanese Baccalaureate, Technical Baccalaureate, French Baccalaureate, IB Diploma, etc.
3. Certified copy of the Lebanese Baccalaureate equivalency for non-Lebanese degrees or diplomas. (French Baccalaureate; International Baccalaureate; etc.)
4. Scores of one of the English proficiency exams (see above).
5. Original or certified copy of personal civil status record (for Lebanese applicants) or photocopies of passport and residence permit (for non-Lebanese Applicants).
6. Three identical recent passport-size, colored photos.
7. Copy of the Lebanese identity card.
8. A non-refundable application fee of USD 30 is paid in cash at the RHU Finance Office or any branch of BankMed.

Admission to the Freshman Program

In addition to the documents required for undergraduate admission to RHU, applicants to the freshman programs must also:

a. Provide a certified copy of Permission from the Equivalence Committee of the Lebanese Ministry of Education to join the Foreign Program/Freshman class
b. Submit the following scores in one of the aptitude tests below before you can enroll at RHU:

Aptitude Test	Freshman Arts	Freshman Sciences
SAT-Scholastic Aptitude Test	870	950
ACT - American College Test	15	17

Requirements of the Freshman Program Equivalency

1- **If your school is accredited by one of the following accrediting boards**, then the above requirements are enough to grant you admission to the sophomore year after you complete the Freshman Program and get the equivalency from the Lebanese Ministry of Higher Education

Accrediting Boards:
- Western Association of Schools and Colleges (WASC)
- Southern Association of Colleges and Schools (SACS)
- AdvancED (Cognia)
- New England Association of Schools and Colleges (NEASC)
- North Central Association of Schools and Colleges (NCASC)
- Northwest Association of Colleges and Schools (NACS)
- Council of International Schools

2- **If your school is not accredited by one of the above accrediting boards**, then you need, in addition to the above two requirements (a & b), to submit ACT Subject Tests during your first year at RHU and before you can start your sophomore year.

Required subjects in the ACT Subject Tests exam are:
- Mathematics I and any other two subjects for Freshman Arts
- Mathematics II and two of the following subjects: Biology, Chemistry, and Physics for Freshman Science

Required scores in the ACT Subject Test:
- A minimum total score of 51 for Freshman Arts with a minimum score of 15 in each subject
- A minimum total score of 60 for Freshman Sciences, with a minimum score of 17 in each subject

Please note the following:

Lebanese students cannot declare a major and join the sophomore class until they satisfy the requirements of the Lebanese Ministry of Education and Higher Education and the RHU freshman program.

Transfer Admission

A student enrolled in an accredited institution of higher education that requires full-time attendance may be admitted as a transfer student to RHU if space in the aspired program is available and the student meets the following conditions:

- Has studied at least one semester in the old institution and has good academic standing
- Was not dismissed from the old institution for disciplinary reasons; and
- Satisfies the admission requirements of the desired program.

A transfer student must submit official transcripts attested by the Ministry of Higher Education in the country of origin, along with a certified copy of detailed course descriptions from the previous institution. Students transferring from outside Lebanon must also submit a letter of accreditation from the Lebanese Ministry of Higher Education.

If it is later discovered that the transfer student was dismissed from their former university for disciplinary reasons, the acceptance will be revoked retroactively.

The Admission Committee of the concerned College reviews the transfer applications. It forwards its recommendations to the Dean, who informs the Director of Admission of the final decision to take action.

Regarding probation and dismissal rules, a transfer student shall be treated as a new student. A regular semester equals a minimum of 12 earned credits for transfer purposes. To earn a bachelor's degree, a transfer student must study at least three regular semesters at RHU for a three-year program or four regular semesters for a four-year program and acquire Co-op work experience.

Transfer Credits

Courses earned by a transfer student before joining RHU may count as RHU credits, subject to the following conditions:

a. The student has attained a minimum Cumulative GPA of 70% or its equivalent, and a grade of 75 or above in the course.
b. The applicable course is deemed equivalent to the course offered at RHU; at least 80% of its contents match, it involves the same components (Lecture, Lab), and it has the same number of credits or more.
c. The credits were earned within three years of the effective transfer date.
d. A transfer student accepted at RHU is required to complete a minimum of half of the credit requirements toward a bachelor’s degree

A “P” grade shall appear on the student's record for each transferred course but will not be included in the calculation of the cumulative GPA.

A student may take a course at RHU for which equivalent course credits were transferred. In this case, either the transferred course or the RHU course, along with the associated grade, shall appear on the student's transcripts.

Non-Degree Admission

Visiting Student

Visiting student status allows students actively pursuing a degree at another college or university to take courses at Rafik Hariri University and transfer credits back to their home institution.

Prospective undergraduate visiting students must meet the following minimum admission requirements:

- Be in good academic standing (With a minimum CGPA of 70% or its equivalent) from a university recognized and approved by RHU.
- Demonstrate English Language Proficiency:
  TOEFL-IBT minimum 65 or above
  IELTS minimum 5.5-6 or above
  RHU in-house TOEFL minimum score 514

The above requirement may be waived for applicants from institutions where English is the language of instruction.

Required Documents:

1. Fill out and submit a relevant application form (a non-refundable application fee applies)
2. Provide an official college/university transcript.
3. Submit written permission from the home institution for the courses to be taken at RHU.
4. Three passport-size photos and a copy of the ID.
5. A non-refundable reservation deposit, which fully applies towards tuition, is to be paid upon acceptance.

Non-degree Student

Students with a recognized secondary school diploma or a university degree who are interested in taking specific courses to enhance their professional growth and skills can join RHU for academic credit.

Prospective undergraduate non-degree-seeking students must meet the following minimum admission requirements:

- Students must have a high school leaving certificate or higher level of education recognized by RHU.

- Demonstrate English Language Proficiency:
  TOEFL-IBT minimum 65 or above
  IELTS minimum 5.5-6 or above
  RHU in-house TOEFL minimum score 514

The above requirement may be waived for applicants from higher education institutions where the language of instruction is English.

Required Documents:

1. Fill out and submit a relevant application form (A non-refundable application fee applies)
2. Provide an official high school leaving certificate or college/university transcript and a copy of the degree/diploma.
3. Three passport-size photos and a copy of the ID.
4. A non-refundable Reservation Deposit, which fully applies towards tuition, to be paid upon acceptance.

Admission to RHU as a visiting or non-degree student doesn't guarantee admission to any of RHU's regular degree programs. Credits taken at RHU may be applied toward an RHU degree if the student reapplies for admission as a regular student and is accepted under the admission criteria.

Auditors

Individuals wishing to attend classes without receiving academic credit may enroll at RHU as auditing students.

Auditors should submit the relevant application form, a non-refundable application fee, a passport-size photo, a copy of their ID, and a non-refundable reservation deposit that applies towards tuition.

Part-Time Students

Students may wish to pursue a degree at RHU part-time, taking less than the full load of 12 credits per semester. This option is possible, provided the maximum duration for receiving a degree is not exceeded. Accordingly, students may be required to enroll full-time for a few semesters to complete their degrees within the sanctioned period.

Admission to Graduate Studies

Admission to any graduate program at RHU is based on merit. It is offered to applicants holding undergraduate degrees from RHU or other accredited institutions. Students can apply to graduate studies for the fall or spring semesters. Applications are available at the Admissions Office or may be downloaded from RHU's website: www.rhu.edu.lb. Please refer to the Graduate Catalog for details on graduate study programs and related regulations.